# Topotecan capsules · small-cell lung cancer

This treatment aims to slow or shrink small-cell lung cancer that has returned after treatment, when repeating the first treatment is not appropriate. Benefit varies; your team explains the aim for you.

Follow the matching capsule prescription and schedule.

## My overall treatment

Take the prescribed topotecan capsules once daily on Days 1–5 of a 21-day cycle. Days 6–21 have no planned topotecan. Up to 6 cycles are planned, with earlier changes if needed.

**Treatment**
Capsules once daily on Days 1–5; repeat every 21 days.

**Review**
Up to 6 cycles; earlier changes if treatment stops helping or toxicity develops.

## A typical 21-day cycle

| Day 1–5 | Day 6–21 |
|---|---|
| Treatment days | Between treatments |

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

## My tests and checks

| When | What is checked | Timing / reason |
|---|---|---|
| **Before treatment** | **Blood count, kidney and liver tests**<br>Required by regimen | Before the first course |
| **During treatment** | **Blood count, kidney and liver tests**<br>Required by regimen | Before each cycle |
| **During / after treatment** | **Scans, review and any tumour markers**<br>Team-agreed plan | Consultant-agreed dates; no fixed scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen |

## Between treatments

- Blood counts can fall after dosing ends; fever, bleeding or feeling suddenly unwell needs an immediate call.
- Recovery is checked before another cycle; no calendar day guarantees that your counts or symptoms have recovered.

Confirm capsule strength, number, dosing days, storage and contact numbers with the pharmacist. Have the planned blood tests and tell the team about symptoms and all medicines. Keep the written prescription and symptom record; start the next cycle only after team confirmation.

**When to get help**

**Call 112 / 999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

**Call oncology immediately:** temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE NUMBERS ONLY — your team must replace these before patient use.**


Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

# What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

### 1. Hair / energy

Topotecan

Hair loss and tiredness may occur; report marked weakness or dizziness.

### 2. Mouth

Topotecan

Tell the team about ulcers or painful swallowing; ask for help if you cannot drink.

### 3. Chest / breathing

Topotecan

New cough, breathlessness or chest pain needs urgent assessment.

### 4. Stomach / bowel

Topotecan

Report persistent diarrhoea or vomiting. Fever with severe tummy pain is urgent.

### 5. Skin / allergy

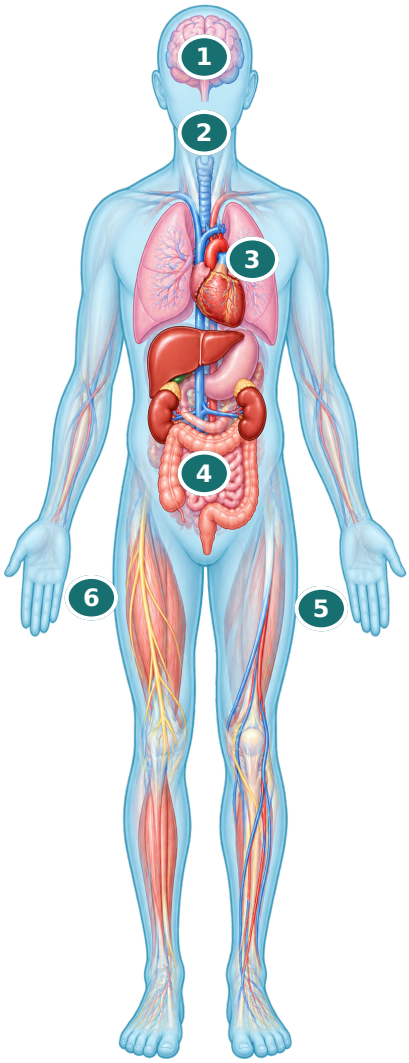
Topotecan

Report spreading rash; swelling or breathing difficulty needs immediate help.

### 6. Blood counts

Topotecan

Fever, unusual bruising or bleeding needs an immediate call. The marker is schematic.




Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Match each number to its symptom box. Blood, skin and nerve markers are schematic.

Call oncology immediately for fever or suddenly feeling unwell, unusual bleeding, severe tummy pain, persistent vomiting or diarrhoea, or new cough or breathlessness. Do not wait for the next cycle. Contact the team immediately for more than 3 episodes of diarrhoea in a day, or sooner if you feel unwell.

**When to get help**

**Call 112 / 999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

**Call oncology immediately:** temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

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# Keep your treatment details to hand

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

**FRONT / CONTACTS**

## My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

**Topotecan capsules**

Days 1–5 every 21 days; up to 6 cycles

Phase: _____ Planned cycles: 6

**Daytime (EXAMPLE)** 087 12345678
**Out of hours (EXAMPLE)** 087 87654321

**Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.**
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

**BACK / CYCLE RECORD**

## My cycle record

Team stamps after each completed cycle.

| C1 | C2 | C3 |
|---|---|---|
| Date / initials | Date / initials | Date / initials |
| C4 | C5 | C6 |
| Date / initials | Date / initials | Date / initials |

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

**FOLD centre — do not cut**

## Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials a cycle when it is complete, after the final planned dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

## Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

### iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

### Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

## Your local contacts and resources

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE NUMBERS ONLY — your team must replace these before patient use.**

Hospital / team: _____ Backup contact route: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.


Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.